Management Console

Table 10.4 shows the most important metrics; we recommend that you monitor them by creating alarms.

Table 10.4 Important metrics for RDS databases from CloudWatch

Name	Description
`FreeStorageSpace`	Available storage in bytes. Make sure you don't run out of storage space. We recommend setting the alarm threshold to < 2147483648 (2 GB).
`CPUUtilization`	The usage of the CPU as a percentage. High utilization can be an indicator of a bottleneck due to insufficient CPU performance. We recommend setting the alarm threshold to > 80%.
`FreeableMemory`	Free memory in bytes. Running out of memory can cause performance problems. We recommend setting the alarm threshold to < 67108864 (64 MB).
`DiskQueueDepth`	Number of outstanding requests to the disk. A long queue indicates that the database has reached the storage's maximum I/O performance. We recommend setting the alarm threshold to > 64.
`SwapUsage`	If the database has insufficient memory, the OS starts to use the disk as memory (this is called swapping). Using the disk as memory is slow and will cause performance problems. We recommend setting the alarm threshold to > 268435456 (256 MB).

We recommend that you monitor these metrics in particular, to make sure your database isn't the cause of application performance problems.